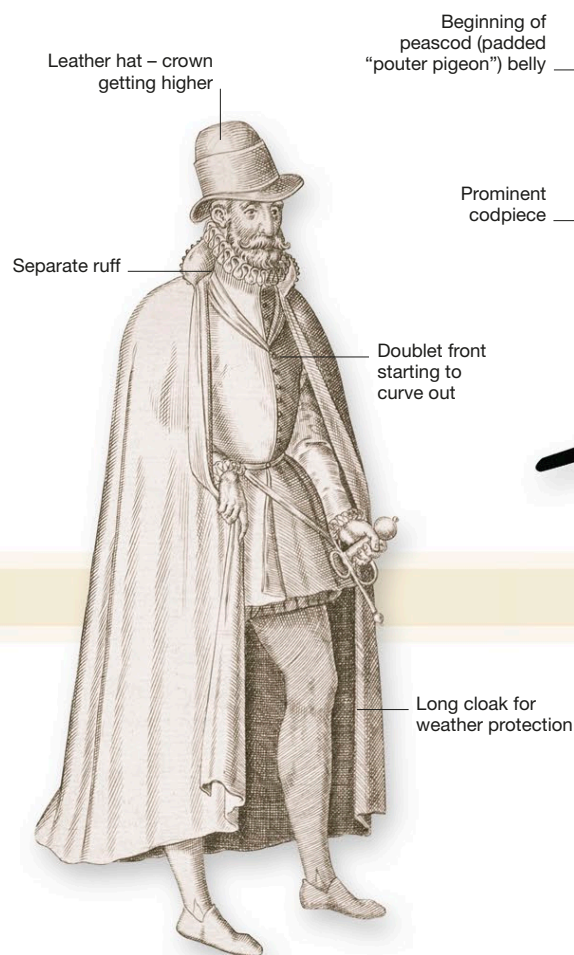


1550–1590

A NEW SUIT

By the late 16th century a “three-piece suit” of doublet, jerkin, and hose with a cloak or robe over the top was worn uniformly by European men. Breeches, trunk hose, and upper stocks were names for trousers in an increasing variety of styles – split-leg garments were definitively male. Although the silhouette moved closer to the rounded lines of the body, careful tailoring and padding helped exaggerate masculine areas such as shoulders, groin, and thighs. Even the most dashing, virile men enjoyed using elaborate textiles and accessories such as earrings, pendants, feathers, and embroidery to express themselves. The dandy and the adventurer coexisted happily; elegant men were expected to dance and write poetry as well as fence, ride, or take a role in politics.



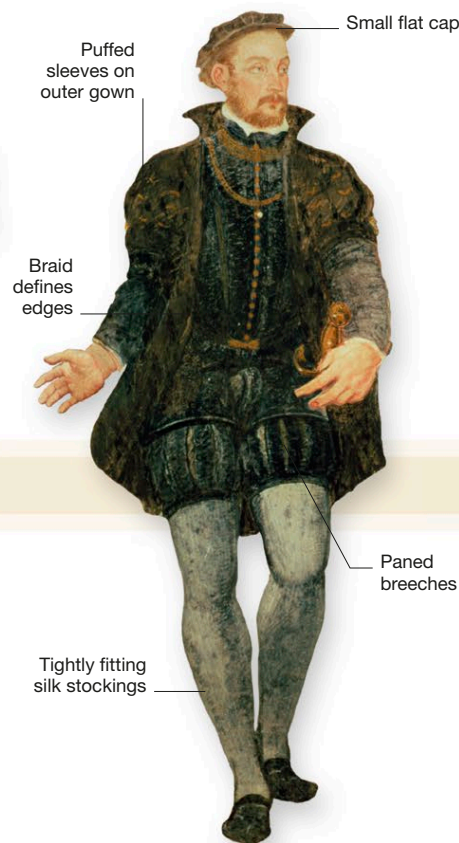
Travel wear Water-resistant longer cloaks covered valuable clothing and unprotected legs. Hats kept in warmth and brims deflected rain. This Low Countries gentleman from around 1580 wears a skirted jerkin that nearly covers his breeches.



Spanish style The horizontal lines decorating the doublet of Don Carlos of Spain in 1564 are typical of the Spanish style. Lines of stitching and heavy braid reinforce the shape. His satin cloak has bands of slashed black velvet as subtle decoration.



Light and shade This portrait of Philip II of Spain shows how the earlier wide shoulders begin to narrow from the 1550s. The dramatic effect of contrasting and extensive gold embroidery enhance his prestige.



Elegant posing This Venetian man’s counterpoint pose suggests classical grace. Wearing clothes well was as important as the clothes themselves. His entirely black ensemble accentuates his pale legs just as the white collar highlights his face.